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MONDAY JANUARY 6, 2025
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WORLD | P10

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THE VIEWS | P8

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BUSINESS | P5

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ENTERTAINMENT | P15

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Courtesy: Presidential Court

UAE, PAKISTAN EXPLORE WAYS TO ENHANCE TIES

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday met with Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif in the city of Rahim Yar Khan in Pakistan. The leaders discussed cooperation between the two countries and ways to enhance ties in several sectors. They also exchanged views on a number of regional and international issues.

Dubai tops Middle East in Global Power City Index

Hamdan: A city's true strength lies not in size or population, but in its vision

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dubai has been ranked first regionally and eighth globally in the 2024 Global Power City Index. This is the second consecutive year the city has achieved this distinction.

The ranking, released by Japan's Mori Memorial Foundation's Institute for Urban Strategies, also makes Dubai the first Middle Eastern city

to secure a place in the top 10. Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of The Executive Council of Dubai, attributed the city's success to the visionary leadership of His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai,

8th

Dubai's ranking globally in the 2024 Global Power City Index

as well as the dedication of Dubai's people and its trusted partners.

In a tweet, Shaikh Hamdan emphasised that Dubai's high ranking reflects its commitment to setting new global benchmarks. "A city's true strength lies not in its size or population, but in its vision, ambition, and ability to inspire the world. Dubai's resilience, determination, and innovation continue to drive its progress and shape a dynamic future," Shaikh Hamdan said.

The top 10 cities in the 2024 Global Power City Index are London, New York, Tokyo, Paris, Singapore, Seoul, Amsterdam, Dubai, Berlin, and Madrid.

NATION

Dh5.4 billion
housing project
for Emirati
newly-weds
approved | P4

BUSINESS

DXB set for
record start
to 2025 with
4.3m guests in
15 days | P5

NATION

Residents
share
memories as
Burj Khalifa
turns 15 | P3



WORLD

HMPV in
China: India
urges calm
amid flu
season | P11

Israel, Hezbollah threats put ceasefire at risk

UN PEACEKEEPERS CITE VIOLATIONS OF 60-DAY DEAL BY ISRAELI TROOPS

BEIRUT

The UN peacekeeping force in Lebanon has accused Israel of a "flagrant violation" of the 2006 Security Council resolution that forms the basis of its November ceasefire with Hezbollah.

The statement from the UN Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL) came as Hezbollah leader Naim Qassem warned the militant group's patience with Israeli violations could run out before the end of the ceasefire's 60-day implementation timeframe.

The fragile truce, which took effect on November 27, has been marked by mutual accusations of violations from both sides.

"This morning, peacekeepers observed an (Israeli military) bulldozer destroying a blue barrel marking the line of withdrawal between Lebanon and Israel in Labbounneh, as well as an observation tower belonging to the Lebanese Armed Forces immediately beside a UNIFIL position there," the peacekeeping force said on Saturday.

"The (military's) deliberate and direct destruction of both clearly identifiable UNIFIL property and

infrastructure belonging to the Lebanese Armed Forces is a flagrant violation of Resolution 1701 and international law."

Israel warns militants

Meanwhile, Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz accused yesterday Hezbollah of not meeting the terms of a ceasefire, warning that if the militants continued to breach the deal, Israel would "be forced to act".

Katz issued his warning after visiting the military's northern command and it followed a similar accusation against Israel by Hezbollah chief Naim Qassem on Saturday.

Katz said Hezbollah had still not withdrawn "beyond the Litani river" in southern Lebanon, as stipulated in the ceasefire deal.

He added that "if this condition is not met, there will be no agreement and Israel will be forced to act on its own to ensure the safe return of residents of the north to their homes."

"We will not allow the creation of a renewed threat to the northern communities and the citizens of the state of Israel," Katz said in a statement issued by his office.

—AFP



SPORT

Can Indian
cricket move
past Virat
Kohli and Rohit
Sharma? | P13

New Abu Dhabi bridges to reduce traffic by 80%

Project to benefit commuters to airport, Musaffah, Hudayriyat Island

ABU DHABI

BY LEKSHMY PAVITHRAN
Assistant Online Editor

Abu Dhabi opened two new bridges connecting Al Khaleej Al Arabi Street and Shakhboub Bin Sultan Street towards Musaffah on Saturday.

The Dh315 million project is expected to cut peak morning traffic at the intersection by up to 80 per cent.

Each bridge has five lanes, with a capacity to handle 7,500 vehicles per hour.

The project includes a three-lane flyover on Al Khaleej Al Arabi Street and a

two-lane bridge connecting Shakhboub Bin Sultan Street to Al Khaleej Al Arabi Street.

The project will benefit commuters travelling to Zayed International Airport, Musaffah, and Hudayriyat Island.

Mohammad Ali Al Shorafa, Chairman of Department of Municipalities and Transport (DMT), stated: "This infrastructure is designed to improve connectivity, reduce congestion, and increase the quality of life for all in Abu Dhabi."

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Each bridge has five lanes, with a capacity to handle 7,500 vehicles per hour.



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